a day and be introduced to sizable groups of local Republican leaders and other people at each stop. The next time you see them, understandably, they all expect you to remember them.

Sometimes, it was even difficult remembering the names of all the members of the White House staff. There were hundreds of them; I'd be introduced to a new staffer, hear the person's name once, then see him or her around the White House and sometimes feel embarrassed that I couldn't instantly recall the name. I've met so many people in my life that whenever I encounter someone, I have to assume I might have met that person previously. Before committing myself, I sort of look for clues and react accordingly—although sometimes that technique backfires. Once back in my Hollywood days, a man came up to me in the lobby of the Plaza Hotel in New York, stuck out his hand, and said, "You don't know me . . ." So many people did that to me that I just said, "Wait a minute, oh sure I do, I'm just trying to remember. . . ."

He said, "No, you *don't* know me, I just wanted to tell you how much I enjoy your television program."

I don't think I'm alone in having this kind of problem. I've heard about all sorts of tricks people use to deal with it. When Babe Ruth would run into somebody and wasn't sure whether he had met the person before, he would give a friendly smile and say, "Your name . . . I'm trying to remember."

The other person might say, "John," and the Babe would say, *"John*, of course I know, it's your last name I can't remember." If the person said, "Smith," Babe would reverse it and say, "No, I know that, I'd just forgotten your first name."

When I'm in a receiving line, I usually stick out my hand and smile in the expectation that the next person might be someone I've met before, and if the man or woman says,